

Report Analyst Course — My Notes

Introduction

- Report Analyst role = turns raw project/meeting/process data into clear, structured reports for stakeholders.
- Course roadmap: roles → skills → knowledge areas → tools (Excel) → Report Analyst vs BA.

Why a Report Analyst is Needed / Report Analyst Roadmap

Why a Report Analyst is Needed

- Projects lose track of progress when meeting outcomes, hours, and activities aren't consistently recorded.
- Without structured reporting, stakeholders and team leads lack visibility into what's actually been done.
- Report Analyst's job = capture, organise, and present that information so it's accurate and easy to review.

Report Analyst Roadmap

- Foundation: understand what data needs to be captured (hours, activities, minutes, decisions).
- Then build practical skills in recording and structuring that data consistently.
- Then tools/templates to standardise reporting across the team.
- Career path is layered, not a single jump — from note-taking to structured analysis and presentation.

Report Analyst Roles and Responsibilities

- Record meeting minutes, hours logged, and activity details for each team member/week.
- Maintain an accurate, up-to-date individual and group reporting log.
- Cross-check reported hours/activities against actual team meetings and tasks completed.
- Bridge communication: raw team activity ↔ a clean report a team leader or lecturer can review.
- Flag gaps, missing entries, or inconsistencies in the reporting log.

Skills Required to Become a Report Analyst

- Attention to detail — accurately capturing hours, dates, and activity descriptions.
- Communication — writing clear, concise activity summaries other people can understand.
- Organisation — keeping a consistent log structure across weeks and team members.
- Data literacy — comfortable working in spreadsheets, tables, and structured templates.
- Time management — logging entries promptly rather than reconstructing them later.
- Domain awareness — understanding the project/course context well enough to summarise it correctly.

Report Analysis Knowledge Areas

(Framework mirrors general reporting/project-tracking practice)

- Reporting planning and monitoring — deciding what gets logged and how often.
- Data collection and collaboration — gathering hours/activities from each team member.
- Report life cycle management — keeping logs current from week 1 through to submission.
- Consistency and structure analysis — checking format, terminology, and layout stay uniform.
- Report design and presentation — organising entries clearly for the reader.
- Report evaluation — reviewing the finished log for completeness and accuracy.

Report Analysis with Excel + Demo

- Organise weekly hours and activity details in a structured spreadsheet.
- Build trackers — individual meeting reports, group logs, hours summaries — in Excel.
- Use formulas and simple summaries (e.g. total hours) to keep the log accurate.

- Present the report to team leads/lecturers in a clear, structured format.

Report Analyst vs BA

- Report Analyst → focused on capturing and structuring team activity, hours, and meeting records → turns these into a clean, reviewable log.
- BA → focused on business problems, processes, and stakeholder needs → turns these into requirements/solutions.
- Overlap: both rely on clear documentation, structured templates, and Excel to support the team.
- Core difference: Report Analyst = activity/reporting focus. BA = requirements/process focus.